

United Overseas Bank (UOBH.SI): First Take: 3Q25 miss on kitchen sinking exercise; outlook inline; Buy

UOB posted **3Q25 net profit of S\$443mn, -72% yoy/-67% qoq, -67% vs. GSe.**

Driving the weaker numbers were largely down to **higher credit cost of 157bps vs GSe's 37bps** with SPs at 55bps and 79bps on GPs. NPAs rose 7.8% qoq (as new NPAs jumped 78% qoq) on higher NPAs in Greater China, ROW with some rise in ASEAN-4 and Singapore as well. With the additional provisions, GP coverage is now at 1% from 0.8% in 2Q and NPA coverage is higher. Elsewhere (1) **Non NII was weaker than GSe** on lower fee income -3% qoq but (2) **NII came in better than expected -3%qoq** with NIM at 1.82% and loan growth of 2.4%qoq. (3) **Cost was well controlled** with CIR at 45.2%.

UOB released 2026 guidance, with (1) Loan growth to be low single digit (GSe of 5%); (2) FY NIM guidance of 1.75% - 1.80% (GSe NIM 1.77%); (3) High single to double digit fee growth (GSe 12%); (4) Credit cost to be between 25-30bps (GSe at 30bps); (5) Low single digit operating expenses (GSe of 1%).

Overall, weaker than expected results on the back of kitchen sinking exercise. We see more clarity is needed on what drove the higher NPA in all regions and if CRE is the only cause of the rise or if there is weakness in the other segments and why despite the additional GPs taken there is still RLAR that has to be set aside. Furthermore, we hope for more clarity on the CRE portfolio and how much provisions have been taken to find comfort in the kitchen sinking. We think the stock price may be weak on the back of these results and await for more comments from management. UOB is holding a media briefing at 8.30am local time, followed by an analyst briefing at 9.45am.

Key highlights:

- **Net interest income was 2% higher than GSe, -3% qoq/-8% yoy.** Loan growth was decent at +2% qoq / +5% yoy. The qoq growth was driven by Singapore, and rest of the world while ASEAN and greater China were flattish.
- **NIM declined 9bps qoq to 1.82%**, inline with GSe of 1.81%, due to asset repricing (-25bps qoq) due to the sharp decline in SORA, while partly cushioned by improved funding cost (-16bps qoq). LDR lowered to 83.7% from 84.7% in 2Q25.
- **Non-interest income was 7% lower than GSe, +0% qoq/ -18% yoy.** Fees and commission gross income increased 8% qoq, supported by wealth on the back of improved investment sentiment, but net fee income was down 3% qoq tapered

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by higher card rewards. Other non-interest income was up 5% qoq.

- **NPL ratio was flat qoq at 1.60%**, as higher upgrades, recoveries and write-offs offset higher new NPL formation qoq.
- **Credit cost came in at 157bp on our calculation.** SP increased to 55bps in 3Q by our calculation and GP increased to 79bps, as UOB pre-emptively provisioned for macroeconomic uncertainties and sector-specific headwinds, and to strengthen GP coverage. NPA coverage improved to 100% from 88% at 2Q25 and unsecured NPA coverage was higher at 240% from 209% at 2Q25.
- **Expenses were inline with GSe**, -3% yoy with cost to income ratio (CIR) for the quarter coming in at 45.2%.

Exhibit 1: 3Q25 earnings summary

Income statement (\$\$mn)						Actual vs. Est			
	3Q24	4Q24	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	YoY %	QoQ %	3Q25E	(%)
Net Interest Income	2,460	2,452	2,409	2,336	2,265	(8)	(3)	2,218	2
Fee & Commission	630	567	694	636	615	(2)	(3)	687	(10)
Other Non-Interest Income	744	442	554	493	518	(30)	5	527	(2)
Non-Interest Income	1,374	1,009	1,248	1,129	1,133	(18)	0	1,213	(7)
Operating Income	3,834	3,461	3,657	3,465	3,398	(11)	(2)	3,432	(1)
Operating Expenses	(1,590)	(1,559)	(1,559)	(1,536)	(1,535)	(3)	(0)	(1,518)	1
Pre-Prov Op Profit (PPOP)	2,244	1,902	2,098	1,929	1,863	(17)	(3)	1,913	(3)
Loan Loss Provisions	(304)	(227)	(290)	(279)	(1,361)	348	388	(320)	325
Pre-tax Profit	1,923	1,685	1,822	1,638	520	(73)	(68)	1,614	(68)
Net Profit	1,610	1,522	1,490	1,338	443	(72)	(67)	1,334	(67)

Balance sheet (\$\$mn)						Actual vs. Est			
	3Q24	4Q24	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	YoY %	QoQ %	3Q25E	(%)
Assets	541,885	537,664	538,009	537,838	555,419	2	3	543,701	2
Gross Loans	333,998	337,831	341,154	342,900	351,084	5.1	2.4	345,880	2
Non-Performing Loans	5,010	5,164	5,458	5,341	5,617	12	5	5,510	2
Customer Deposits	400,784	403,978	401,250	405,076	419,660	5	4	411,695	2

CAMEL Ratios (%)						Actual vs. Est			
	3Q24	4Q24	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	YoY %	QoQ %	3Q25E	(%)
Core Tier 1	15.2	15.4	15.4	15.1	14.5			14.8	
NPL Ratio	1.50	1.53	1.60	1.56	1.60			1.59	
Provisions / Average Loans (bps)	37	27	34	33	157			37	
Reported Net Interest Margin	2.05	2.00	2.00	1.91	1.82			1.81	
Cost-to-Income Ratio	41.5	45.0	42.6	44.3	45.2			44.2	
Loan-to-Deposits	83.3	83.6	85.0	84.7	83.7			84.0	

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

We are Buy rated on UOB. Our 12-month 2-stage DDM-based target price is S\$42.10. Downside risks: Unexpected acceleration or deeper Fed cut cycle. Changes in strategy to return capital. Unexpected deterioration in asset quality.

UOBH.SI	12m Price Target: S\$42.10	Price: S\$34.87	Upside: 20.7%		
Buy	GS Forecast				
Market cap: S\$58.0bn / \$44.4bn 3m ADTV: S\$106.8mn / \$82.9mn Singapore Asean Financials M&A Rank: 3		12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
	Net inc. (S\$ mn)	6,044.0	5,474.0	5,824.0	6,245.2
	EPS (S\$)	3.51	3.22	3.43	3.68
	EPS growth (%)	6.0	(8.4)	6.5	7.4
	P/E (X)	8.9	10.8	10.2	9.5
	P/B (X)	1.1	1.2	1.2	1.1
	ROA (%)	1.1	1.0	1.0	1.1
	ROE (%)	13.1	11.3	11.8	12.1
	Price/PPOP (X)	7.1	7.4	7.2	6.8
	Dividend yield (%)	7.3	5.2	5.2	5.6
		3/25	6/25E	9/25E	12/25E
EPS (S\$)	0.88	0.77	0.79	0.76	

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 5 Nov 2025 close.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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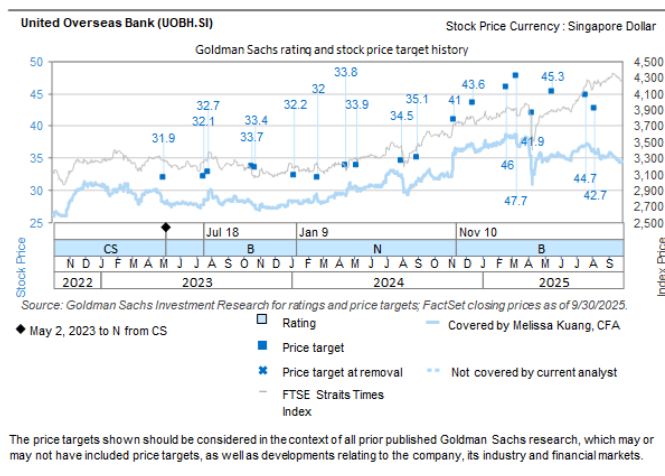
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